



FINE DINING

Many airlines partner with celebrity chefs who curate a blissful epicurean experience

EXCLUSIVE ACCESS

First Class lounges offer exclusivity and an à la carte fine dining experience



AIRPORT ROYALTY

If you're flying First Class, you're airport royalty, and everyone around you seems determined to make your journey as seamless and luxurious as possible. Take Mumbai, for instance. Once you're handed that precious boarding pass for 1A or 1F, an attentive staff member will escort you to the Adani lounge, engaging in polite conversation as you glide through the formalities. Inside the lounge, you'll be ushered into a private, roped-off section where Chef Anirudh Limaye, who previously led kitchens at several Marriott hotels, is on standby. And when you land back in Mumbai? A buggy will be waiting to whisk you straight to immigration—all complimentary, of course.

But the real decadence happens at First Class lounges abroad. Dubai is a wine lover's dream. The selection is so exquisite, with bottles like Château Margaux or Château Mouton Rothschild offered in the lounge, that it's quite easy to drink your ticket's worth (but please don't!). In Singapore, First Class passengers are invited to the 'Private Room,' a lounge so exclusive it makes the regular First Class lounge feel pedestrian. Here, you'll find private bedrooms and showers, perfect for those long layovers. And in Doha, Qatar Airways' sprawling lounge boasts the Qspa, a wellness retreat, complete with a jacuzzi and massage rooms.

And once you step onboard, it becomes clear almost instantly—this isn't just a seat. It's a luxurious throne, designed to cocoon you in comfort and transform into a bed so soft, you'll wonder if you've ever slept this well before. Every detail is customisable, every corner of your space tailored to your liking—whether you're planning to catch up on work, relax with a movie, or simply drift into a deep, restorative sleep. But what truly sets the experience apart is the service. The cabin crew doesn't just cater to your needs; they anticipate them. Nothing is too much to ask, and while it may feel a bit over the top, that's the point of First Class.

And what is First Class without caviar? Most top-tier airlines offer it, but Emirates is the most generous, where second helpings are encouraged. Pair your caviar with Krug Grande Cuvée if you're flying Singapore Airlines, or with Dom Pérignon on Emirates, the world's biggest buyer of the iconic champagne.

In the end, the art of flying is about more than just getting from one place to another. If you can afford it, whether by means or miles, treat yourself. Because in the world of luxury travel, sometimes the journey can be as rewarding as the destination. **BT**

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